

Vildana Razumova

AI/ML Project Lead | From business problem to production

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Ask my AI assistant about my work: vildanarazumova.github.io/about-me

AI/ML Project Lead with a 10+ year background in banking analytics and risk management and 1.5 years in e-commerce product delivery. Since October 2025 ML Project Lead at a tour operator, from business problem to production: price recommendations on LightGBM and business rules, an LLM assistant on Dify in Microsoft Teams, REST API integrations and daily data pipelines in Airflow and n8n. M.Sc. in Data Science, AI and Digital Business (thesis graded 96/100) and an MBA. Open to AI automation and AI or analytics product roles in a team; on-site, hybrid or remote.

Experience

Fun&Sun: a leading tour operator in Central Asia

Remote from Germany

ML Project Lead (freelance)

October 2025 - present

Lead of the ML pricing project. Every project from requirements and as-is analysis to production, with Teams alerts on usage and system health.

- Built price recommendations for package tours: a LightGBM demand forecast with time-series cross-validation, combined with business rules learned from managers' past decisions; every recommendation is explained in plain language. In pilot: managers decide, nothing changes automatically. Forecast MAE 0.268 vs 0.395 for a naive baseline (32% lower), time-series cross-validation.
- Designed and built competitor price monitoring: an integration with an external data API and a daily Airflow pipeline with completeness checks and monitoring. Replaced manual collection that took up most of the working day of the team responsible. In production, handed over to another team with a runbook.
- Built an LLM assistant for payment status questions: analysed six months of staff requests, wrote the scenarios and built the assistant on Dify in Microsoft Teams, with permissions and automated quality checks; for problem cases it opens a Jira ticket routed to the right team. In production since July 2026.
- Delivered a REST API integration with a state registration service in n8n and PostgreSQL (retries, duplicate protection, daily reconciliation) and the PostgreSQL data layer for a traveller document web service that a developer, an infrastructure engineer and I launched in two days. In production.
- Run every project with a second brain: decisions, correspondence, meeting transcripts, implementation, experiments and an onboarding document in one searchable place (SharePoint), plus AI reviewers with separate roles (Claude) and tests and data checks before every production change, so a project can be handed over to a new person painlessly. In daily use.

Stack: Python · SQL · pandas · scikit-learn · LightGBM · PostgreSQL · Airflow · n8n · Dify · Claude API · Claude Code · FastAPI

Linde GmbH: Digital Transformation & Adoption Team

Pullach, Germany

AI Project Manager (internship during the Master's)

July 2025 - December 2025

- Built a Power Automate workflow for content approval and supported the launch of an internal AI podcast; built a learning progress dashboard and used it to improve communication for a learning path on the global learning platform.
- Product work on internal AI tools: user interviews and feedback, a test concept and test runs, documentation, a prioritised feature list and an MVP roadmap for an internal generative AI agent.
- Official internship reference with the top overall rating.

Self development: relocation to Germany

Ingolstadt, Germany

Career break

May 2023 - June 2024

- Moved from Kazakhstan to Germany. Passed the German B1 exam and completed a B2 course.
- Admitted to the M.Sc. in Data Science, AI and Digital Business at GISMA University of Applied Sciences.

Choco Holding (Chocofamily): e-commerce group, #1 discount service in Kazakhstan

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Project Manager and Business Analyst

September 2021 - May 2023

Coordinated two teams of 7 developers and QA engineers: one improving the website and mobile app, one automating internal business processes. Introduced Scrum in a team of 8.

- Saved 350+ working hours per month for 50+ internal CRM users by optimising 10+ business processes.
- Increased successful payments by 33% by fixing the payment method used by 73% of users; conversion to purchase +23% after UX changes on the main screen.

- Reduced a backlog of 500 issues by 40% with prioritisation frameworks; tech debt down 60% and development speed +55% after introducing Scrum.
- Managed requirements and their changes, wrote technical documentation with UML and BPMN, ran discovery phases and audits of existing solutions.

Halyk Bank: the largest universal commercial bank in Kazakhstan

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Three analytics roles in 10+ years, all about optimising financial processes and automating business processes.

Senior Operational Risk Manager, Financial Risk and Portfolio Analysis

October 2017 - September 2021

- Automated the loss event database (100K+ events), saving 1,040 working hours a year for 2 employees; automated management reports on profit and operational risk.
- Investigated internal and external fraud in 50+ cases under the Basel principles; 10+ scenario analyses across 5+ divisions and 20 key risk indicators across 10 divisions.
- Reviewed 100+ new products and processes to identify and reduce operational risks.

Financial Analyst, Retail Sales

July 2014 - October 2017

- Reviewed the financial results of 22 branches and 3,000 sub-branches; automated 10+ reports on payment devices and branch efficiency, saving 3+ hours of manual work daily.

Financial Accounting Analyst, Accounting and Reporting

June 2011 - June 2014

- Prepared 30+ monthly regulatory reports to the National Bank of Kazakhstan; automated 30+ reports via SAP integration (loans, deposits, cards), regulator fines down from 4 a year to 0.

Certifications

Statistics and A/B Testing Stepik

October 2024

SQL Level Up Stepik

October 2024

Business Analysis in IT (BPMN, UML) Aleksander Belin School of Business Analysis

May 2022

Fast Track to MVP: Lean Strategies for Product Innovation; Digital Enthusiast: New Product Development

Education

Master in Data Science, AI and Digital Business

Berlin (Potsdam), Germany

GISMA University of Applied Sciences

2024 - 2026

- Thesis: Multi-Horizon Load Factor Forecasting for B2B Charter Flights: A Machine Learning Approach. Grade 96/100.

Master of Business Administration (MBA, AMBA-accredited programme)

Almaty, Kazakhstan

Almaty Management University (AlmaU)

2018 - 2019

Bachelor in Finance

Almaty, Kazakhstan

International Academy of Business (now Almaty Management University)

2007 - 2011

Hard & Soft Skills

Machine Learning: Python, SQL, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn, LightGBM, XGBoost, time-series forecasting and cross-validation, feature engineering, explainable AI (SHAP), model evaluation, NLP

LLM & AI Automation: Claude API, Claude Code, Azure AI Foundry, Dify, AI assistants in Microsoft Teams, n8n, LLM applications and evaluation, prompt engineering, AI agents, FastAPI, REST API integration, Power Automate

Data Engineering & BI: PostgreSQL, ClickHouse, MSSQL, Airflow, Docker, data pipelines, data modelling, data-quality monitoring, Power BI, DAX, Microsoft Excel, SAP FI

Business & Product: Business analysis (BPMN, UML), requirements management, Scrum, prioritisation (RICE, MoSCoW, ICE), Jira, Confluence, Miro, Figma, operational risk management, stakeholder management

Soft Skills: Clear communication, analytical problem solving and risk assessment, structured work with stakeholders, adaptability and fast learning, ownership of results

Languages

English: professional working proficiency • German: B1 certified, B2 course completed • Russian: native